



STEAM APP REDESIGN

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01

BACKGROUND



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WHAT IS STEAM



STEAM MOBILE



THE GAP

Steam has its own app, but people don't like it.





Steam Mobile

Entertainment

Free

 Share

9.7K RATINGS

2.6

★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆

AGES

13+

Years

I am FRUSTRATED. Mobile Authenticator DOES NOT WORK!... 06/07/2024
★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆ _Lunar_

The STEAM application on my computer told me to download the mobile application to remove the trade/market holds. This was my first time using the STEAM market, so I thought that sounded great! It worked the moment I activated the Authenticator, allowing me to sell and trade cards. Two days later, my account suddenly has the holds again. I thought I'd simply refre [more](#)

Terrible, only get if you have to. 09/12/2023
★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆ please12...

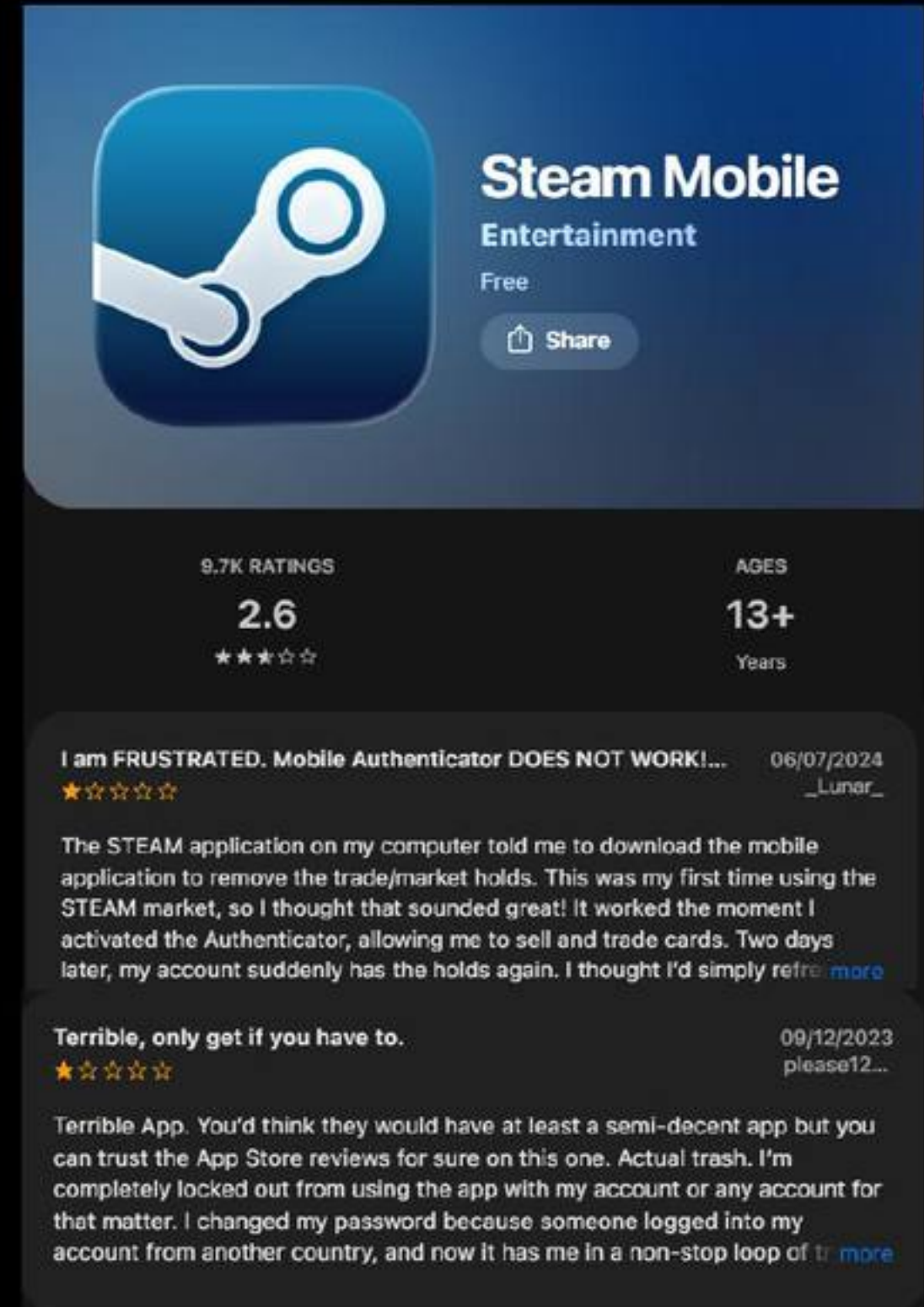
Terrible App. You'd think they would have at least a semi-decent app but you can trust the App Store reviews for sure on this one. Actual trash. I'm completely locked out from using the app with my account or any account for that matter. I changed my password because someone logged into my account from another country, and now it has me in a non-stop loop of tr [more](#)

THE GAP

Most gamers don't use it, then:

- What exactly do they expect to obtain from the app?
- Any pain points or needs from their recent experience of finding, sharing and purchasing games could be solved through redesign of the app?

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02

RESEARCH



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SECONDARY RESEARCH

36%

of respondents find it difficult to discover new PC games to play

94%

take reviews into account when buying one

Youtube

is PC gamer's top platform for discovering new games

FINDING GAMES

87%

of PC gamers say discounts are important

50%

of their library sitting unplayed for median Steam user

188.8 Billion

of global gaming market.

43%

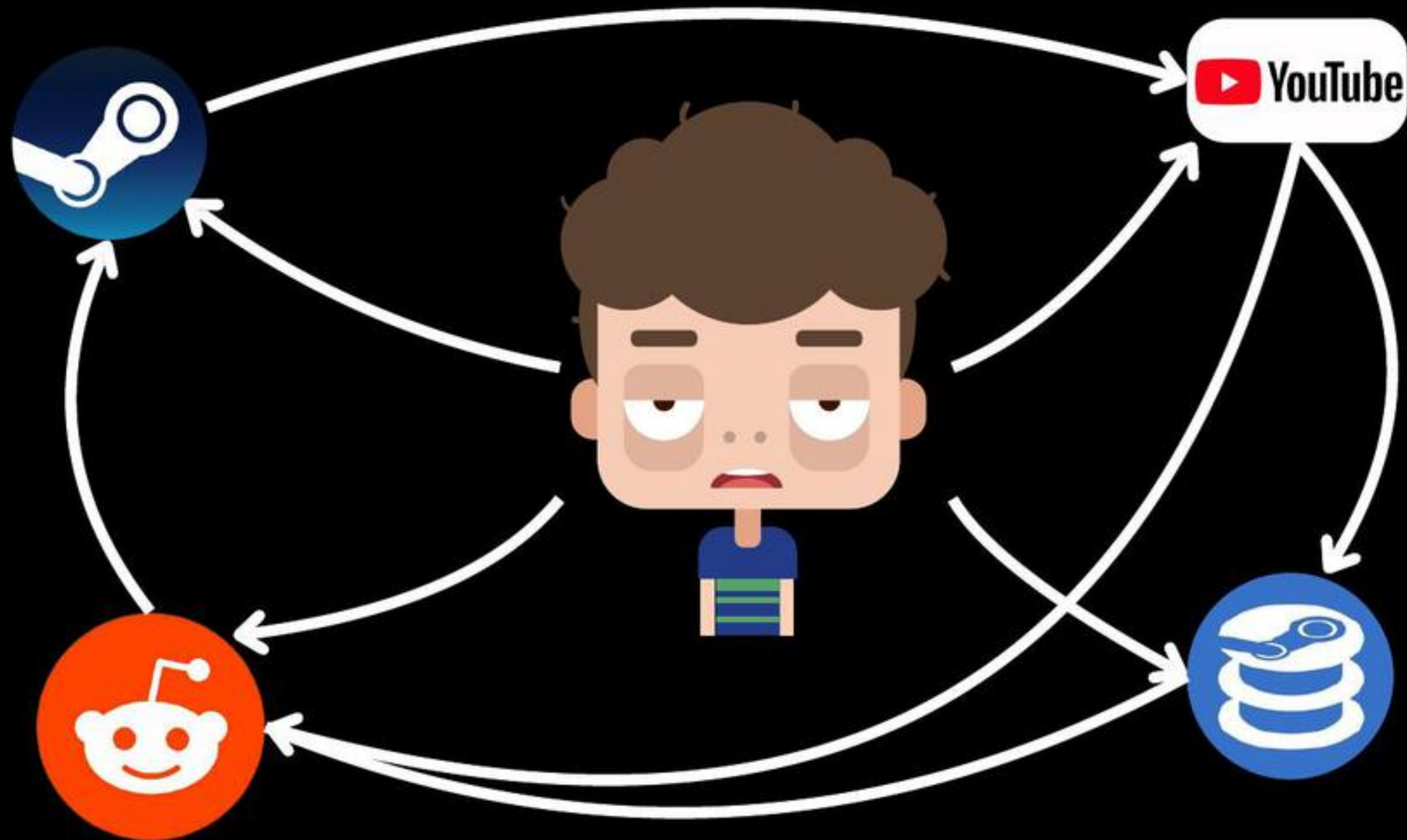
of the global market are PC and console game.

DISCOUNTS

POST-PURCHASE

MARKETS

TYPICAL USER FLOW



USER INTERVIEW

12 Users Interviews& Findings



Pain Points



KEY FINDINGS



1. Fragmented Information Acquisition: 91% of players rely on multiple channels like Steam, YouTube, and Reddit to gather game information.

"I care a lot about reviews. I usually read reviews on Steam, but I also watch YouTube reviewers."

KEY FINDINGS



2. Lack of Trust in Reviews: 58.3% of players express distrust in Steam's built-in reviews, requiring external verification.

"Really care about the reviews. But prefer not to look the Steam's review system. Will look the reviews on the video websites and social media accounts"

KEY FINDINGS



3. Severe Post-Purchase Backlog: 89% of players admit owning games they haven't played or have barely touched, with 67% of these purchases made impulsively during sales.

"20% - 25% of the library never or seldom played. Because the discount, or friends' recommendation"

KEY FINDINGS



4. External Tool Dependency: 75% of players use third-party tools like SteamDB to track discounts and compare prices.

“If I really want to get a game and if not a pc game, will google to search for the best price and order. if everything the same, I'll just go to amazon”

PAIN POINTS

Decision Fatigue

Due to fragmented information and a lack of trust, users often feel exhausted and anxious before making a purchase.

PAIN POINTS

Fear of Missing Out (FOMO)

Disorganized official discount notifications force users to rely on overwhelming third-party tools, leading to anxiety about missing the best price.

PAIN POINTS

Post-Purchase Regret

83.3% of players report regret, primarily because the actual gaming experience (e.g., difficulty, enjoyment) did not meet pre-purchase expectations.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Players face a fragmented game-buying experience, jumping between platforms for reviews and prices. This causes decision fatigue, 83% regret impulse purchases driven by FOMO, and 89% have unplayed games.



PERSONA



ALEX

Software
Engineer /
Hardcore PC
Gamer

Bio

Alex is a tech-savvy gamer with a large Steam library who frequently browses games.

Behavior

- Follows creators and communities for new releases
- Tracks discounts externally
- Frequently forgets wishlisted games
- Shares recommendations with friends
- Balances rational buying with hype-driven decisions

Motivations

- Find all relevant game info quickly
- Reduce uncertainty when buying games
- Maximize value in purchase decisions

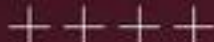
Struggles

- Scattered game information
- FOMO-driven purchases
- Post-purchase regret



03

IDEATE&PROTOTYPE



HOW MIGHT WE...

help players assess
whether a game fits their
preferences?

centralize information to
reduce friction?

encourage thoughtful
purchasing behavior over
FOMO-driven decisions?

SYSTEM STRUCTURE

Explore Page

Personalized feed
content

Community Hub

Followed users
contents

Store Page

Personalized game
recommendation

Fit score Page

Wishlist+ Shopping
Cart

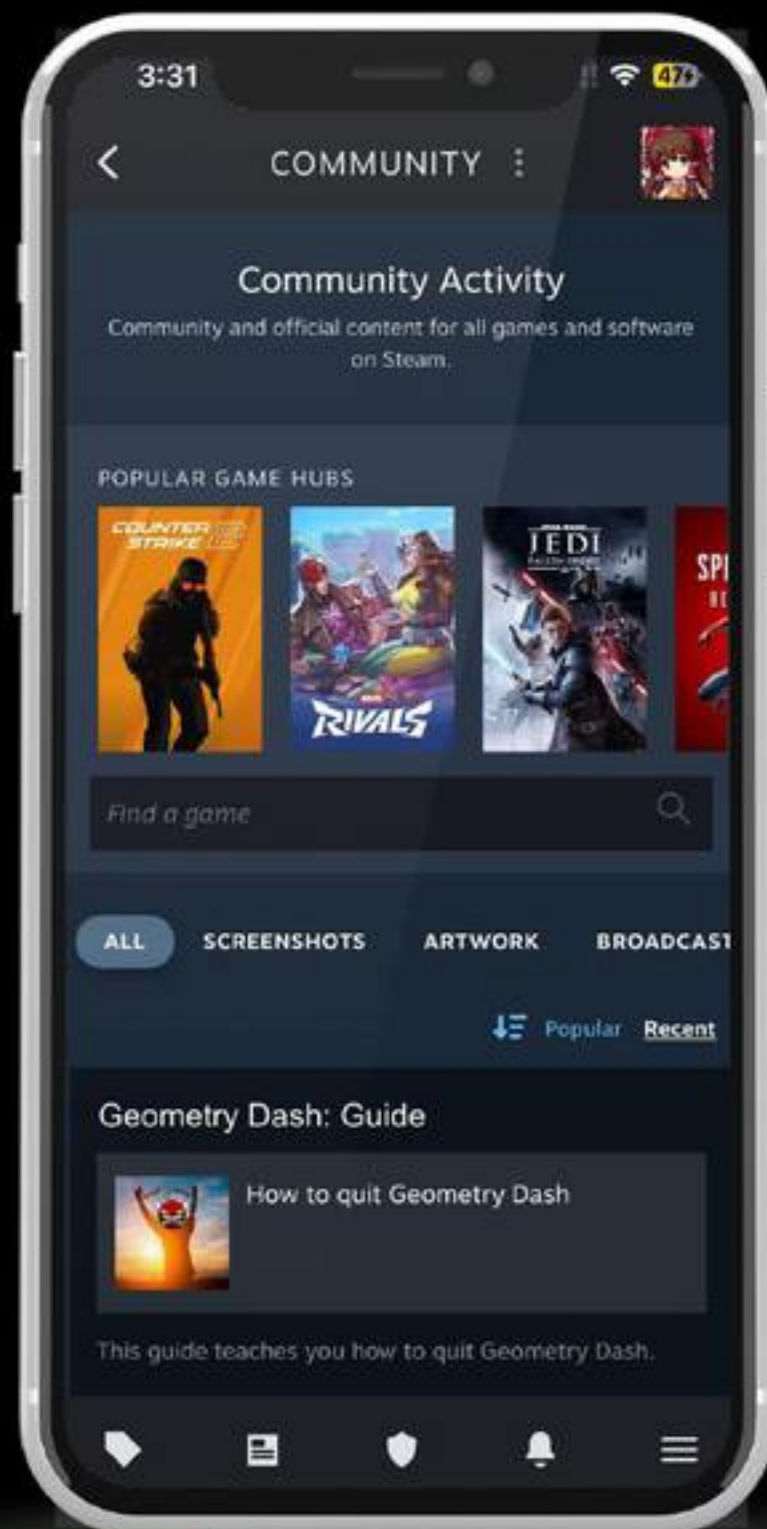
Wallet Page

Trade-in feature



COMMUNITY HUB

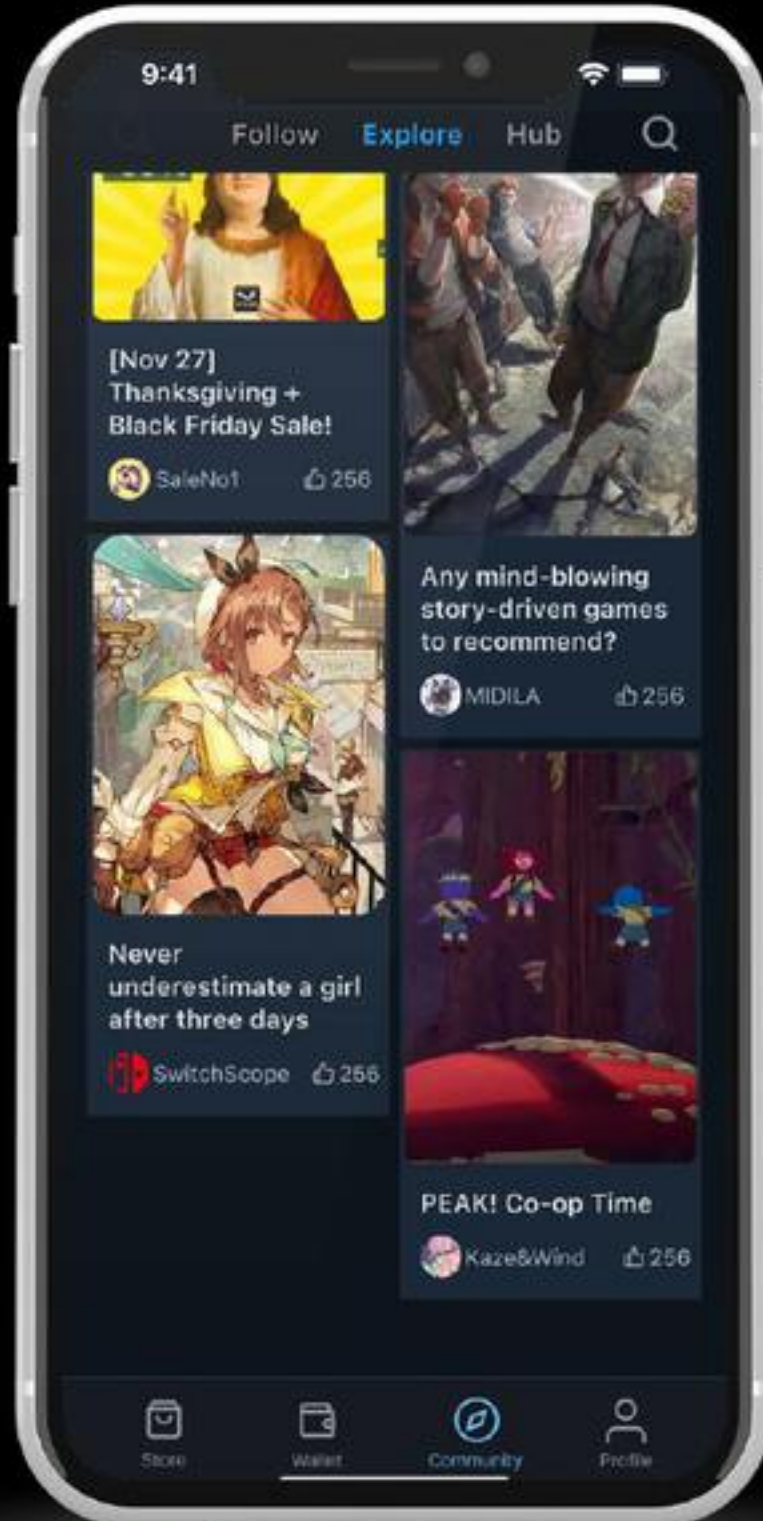
Original



Our Design (Explore Page)



Explore Page



Post Details



Followed Page



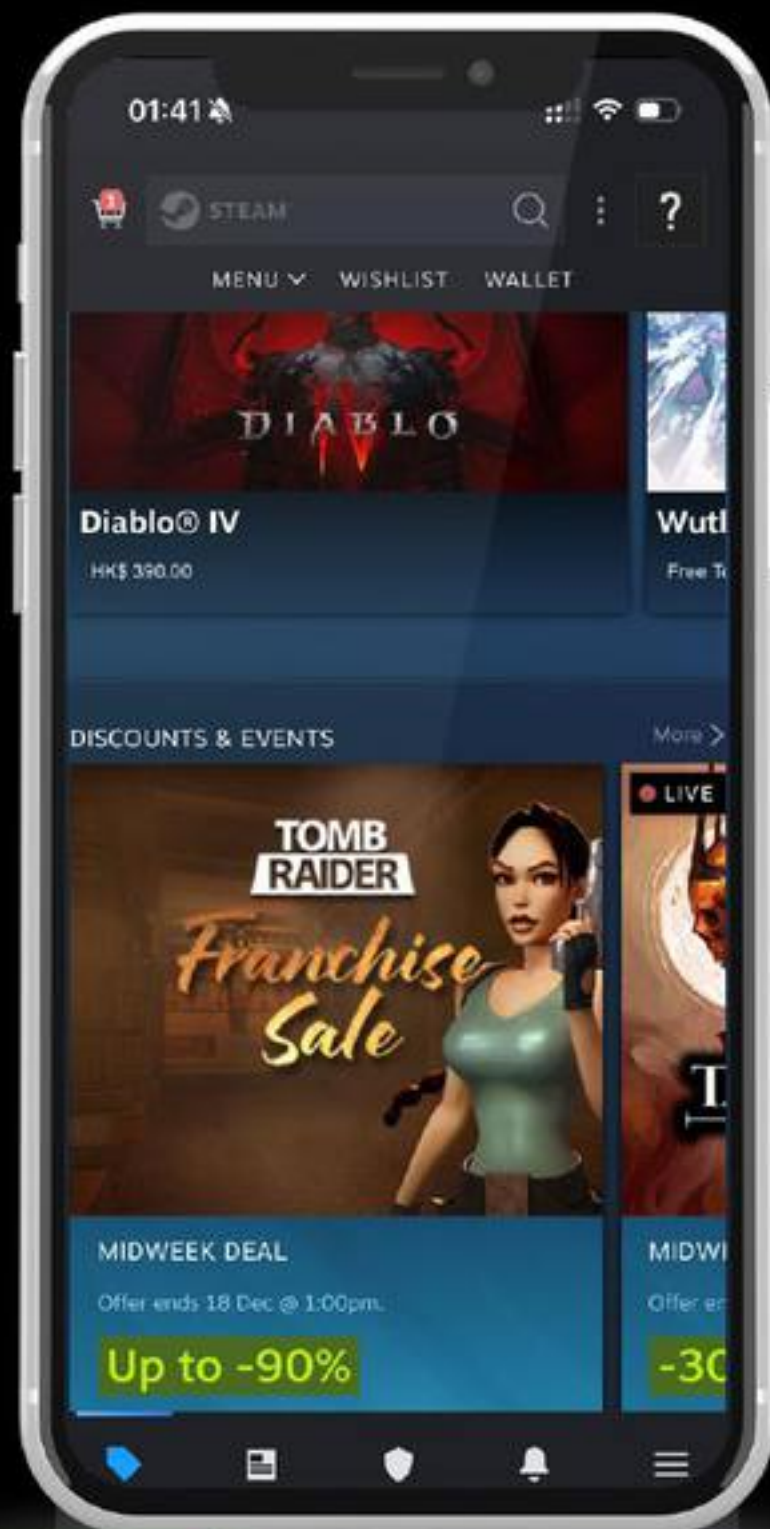
Zone Page





DISCOUNT DISCOVERY

Original

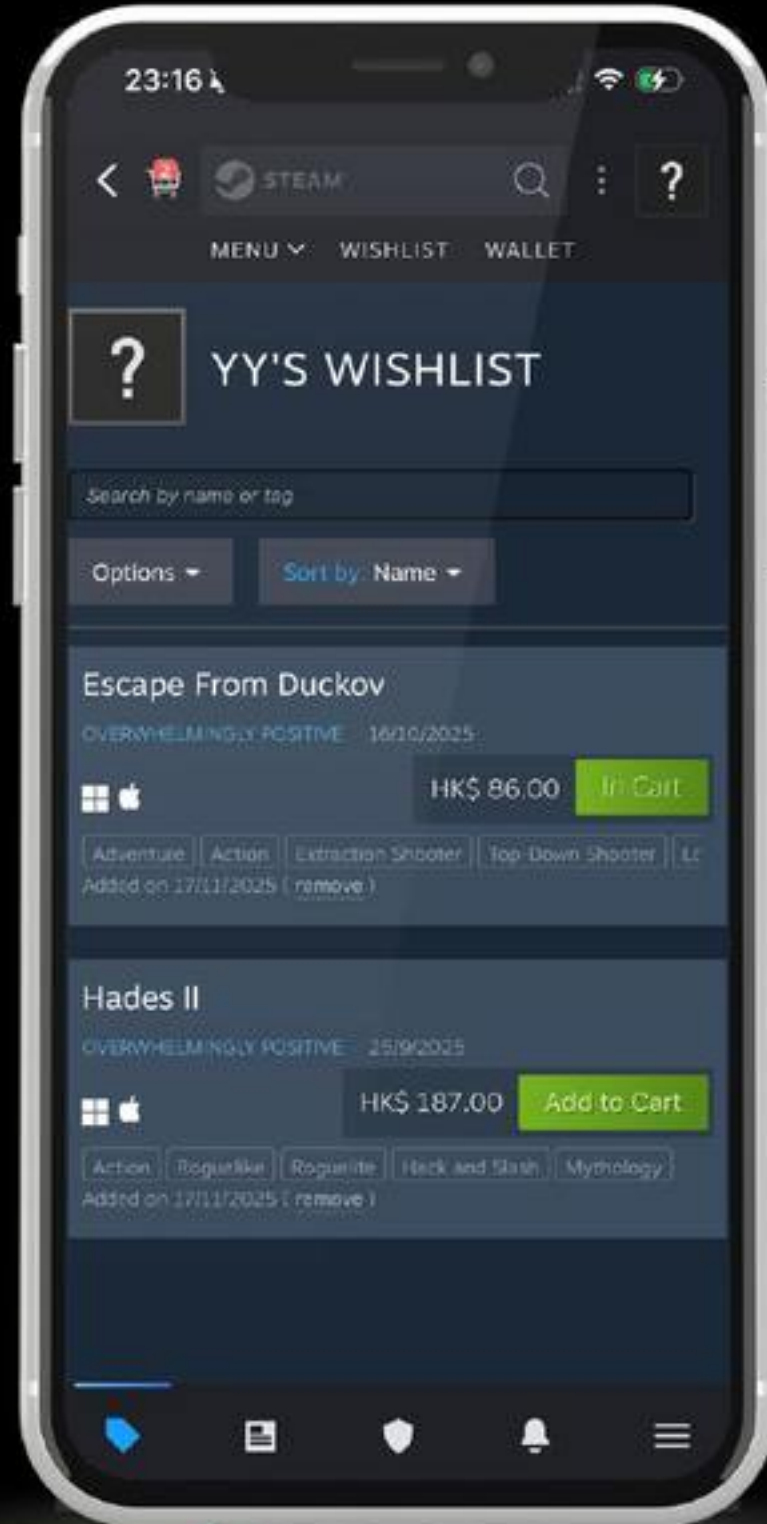


Our Design

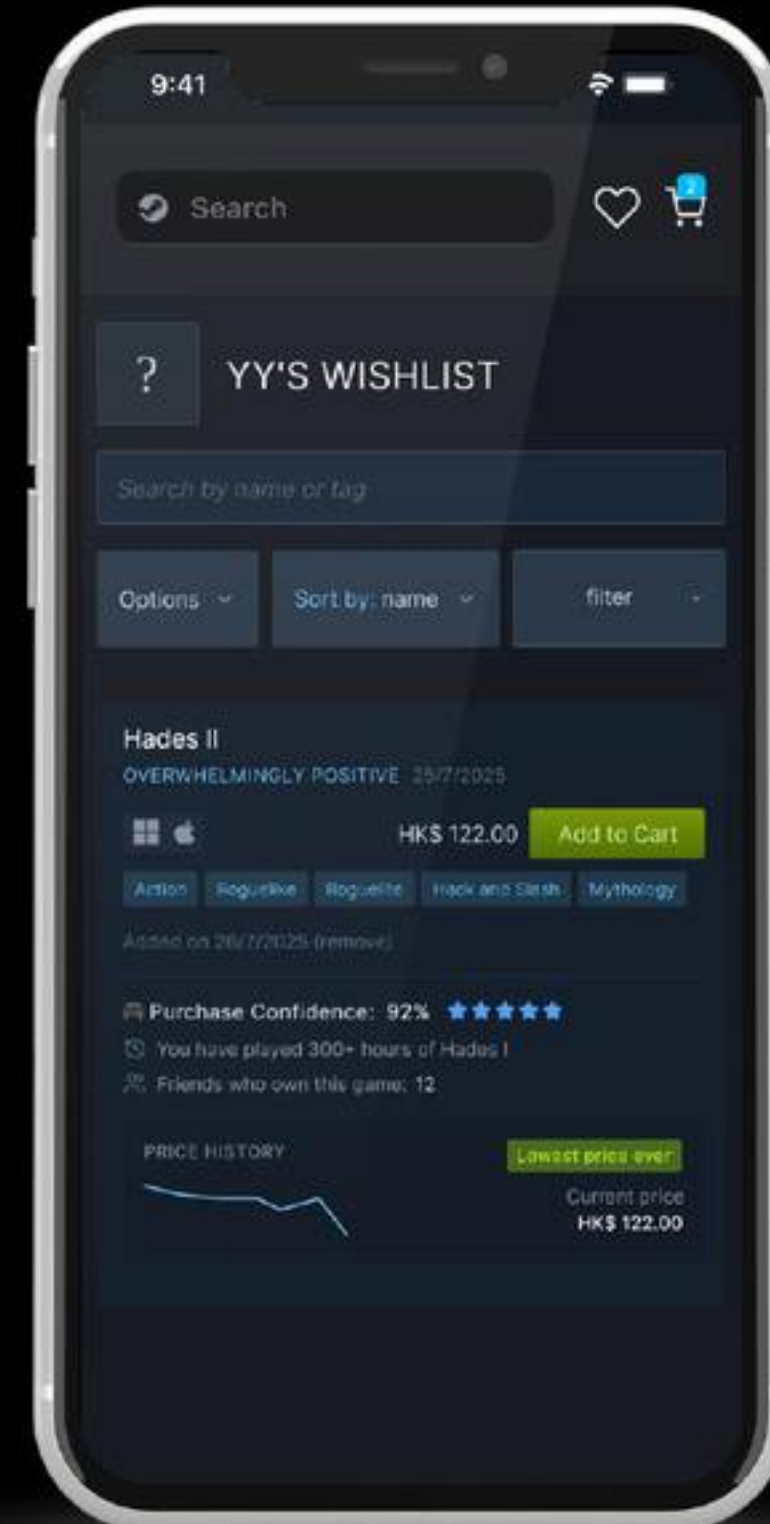


WISHLIST

Original



Our Design

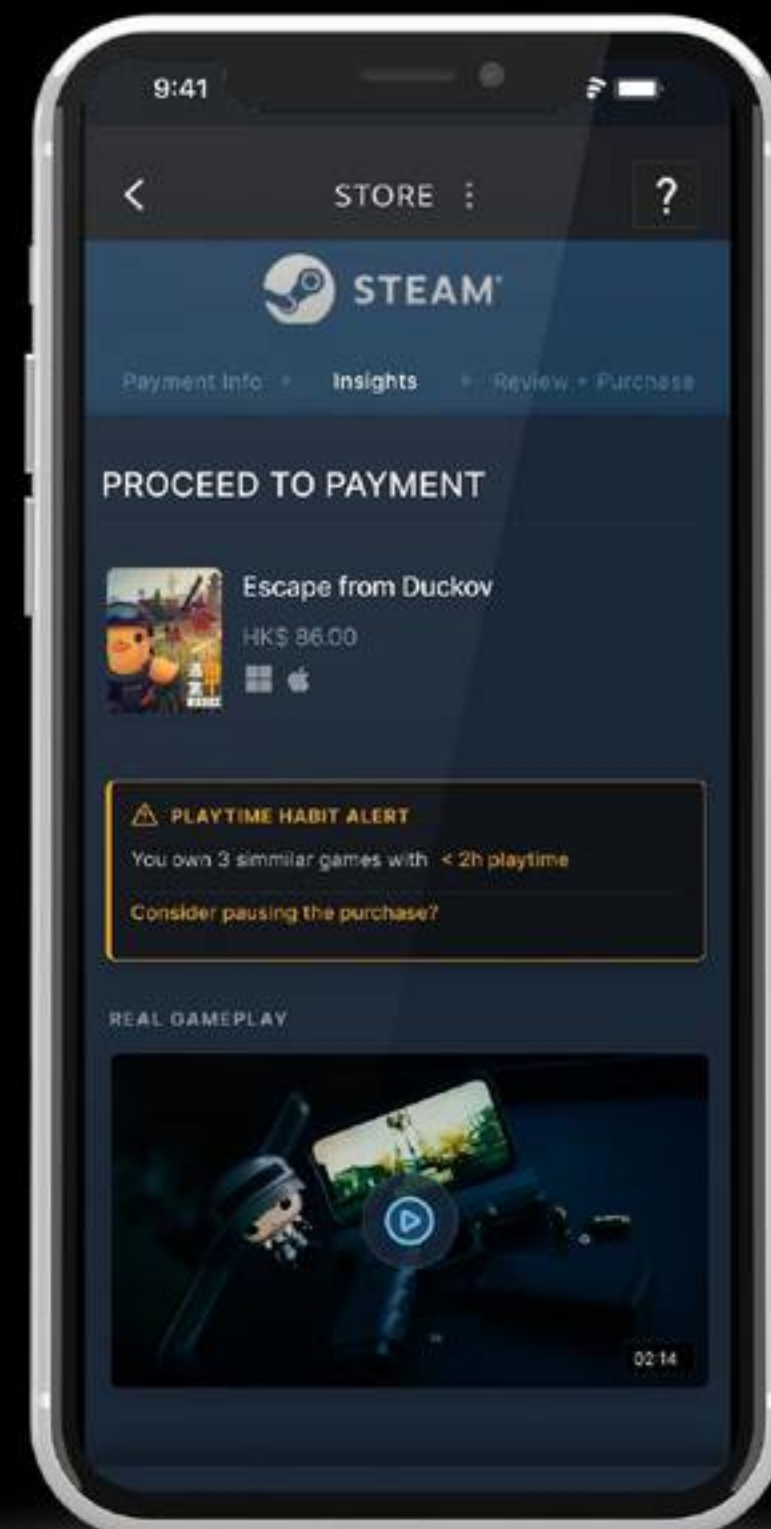


SHOPPING CART

Original



Our Design

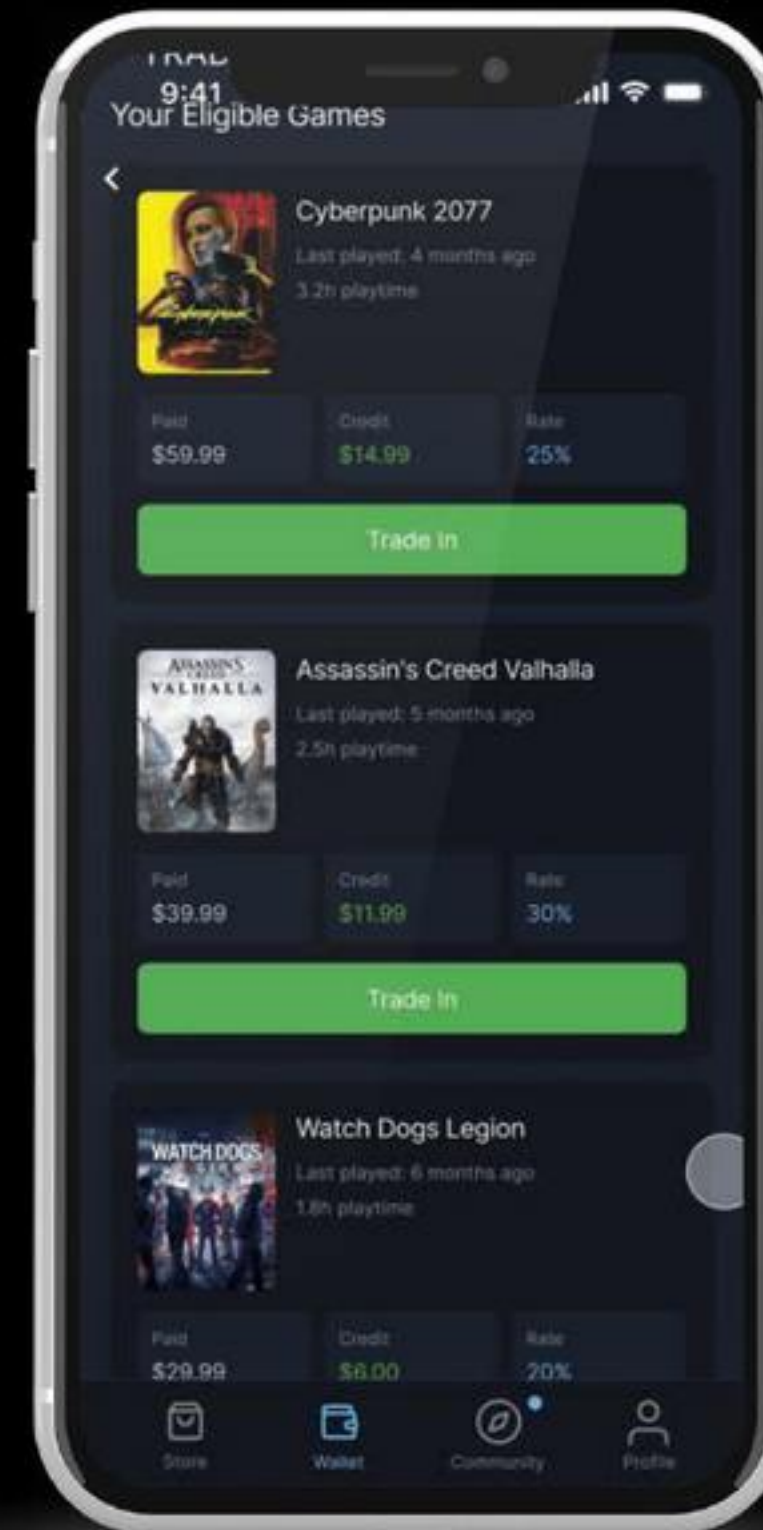
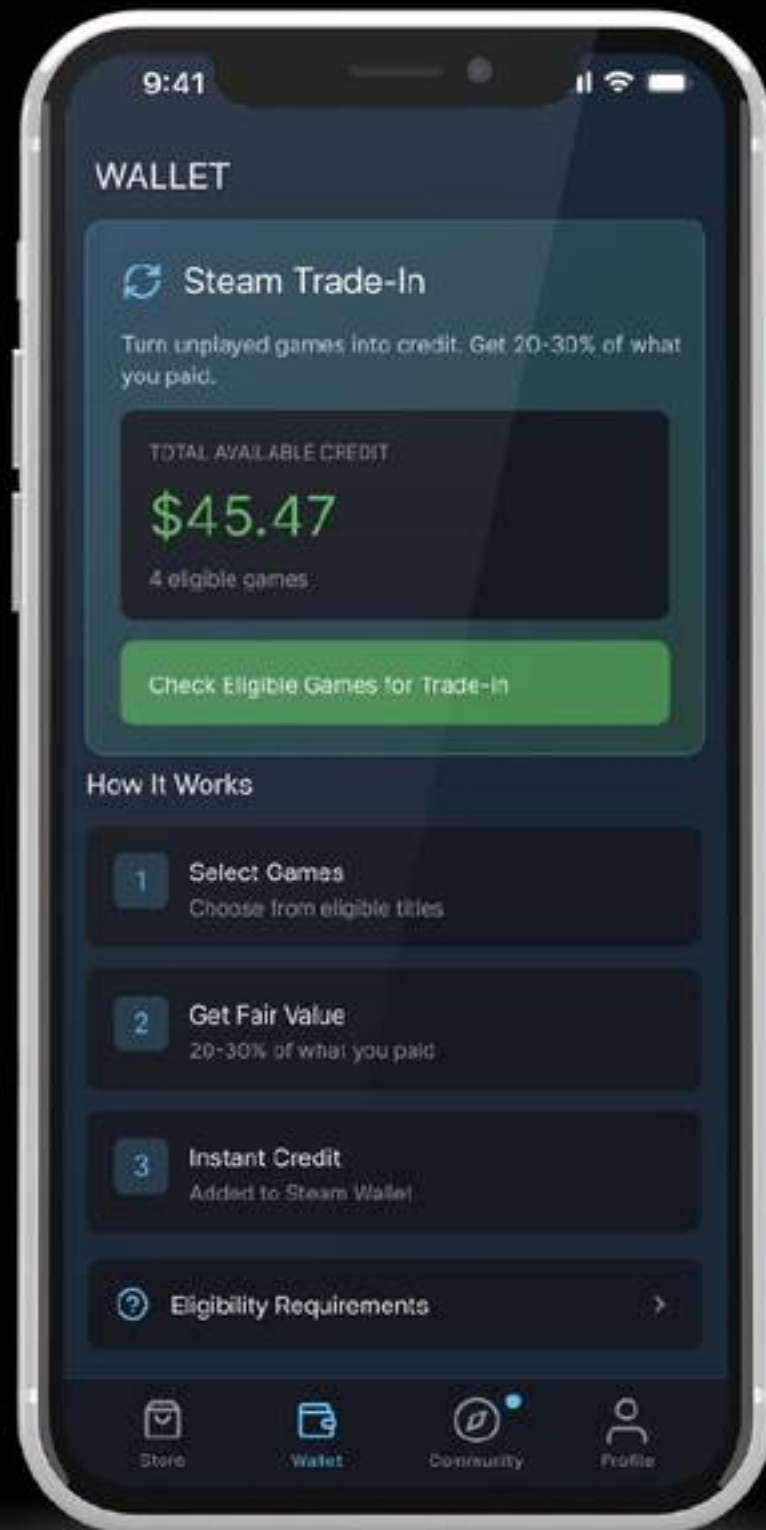


FIT SCORE SYSTEM





TRADE-IN



USABILITY TEST INSIGHTS

What Worked



- Trade-in concept
- Price history
- Community browsing

What Didn't



- Text-heavy pages
- Unclear logic
- Intrusive alerts
- Long checkout



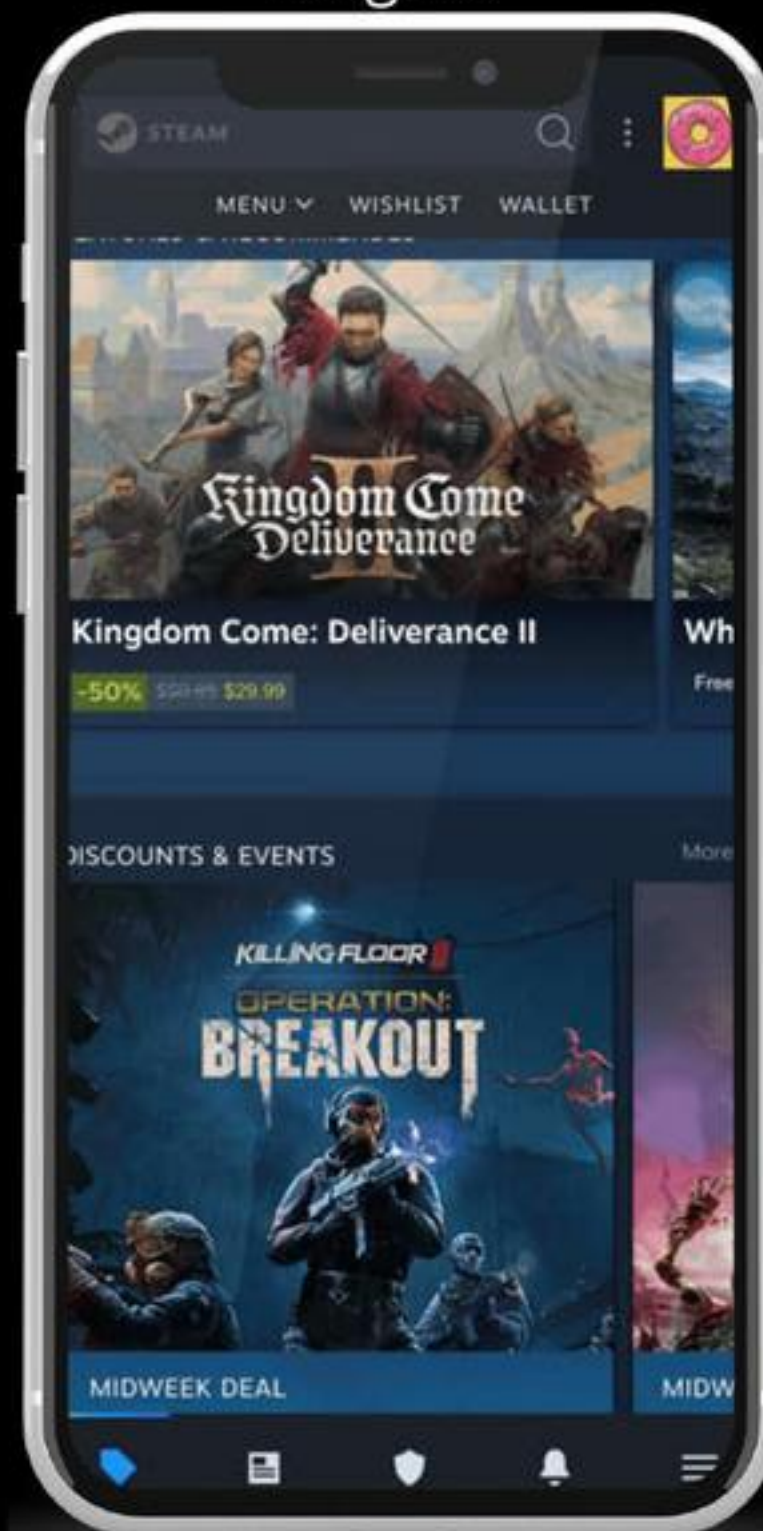
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**POST-USABILITY
DESIGN ITERATION**

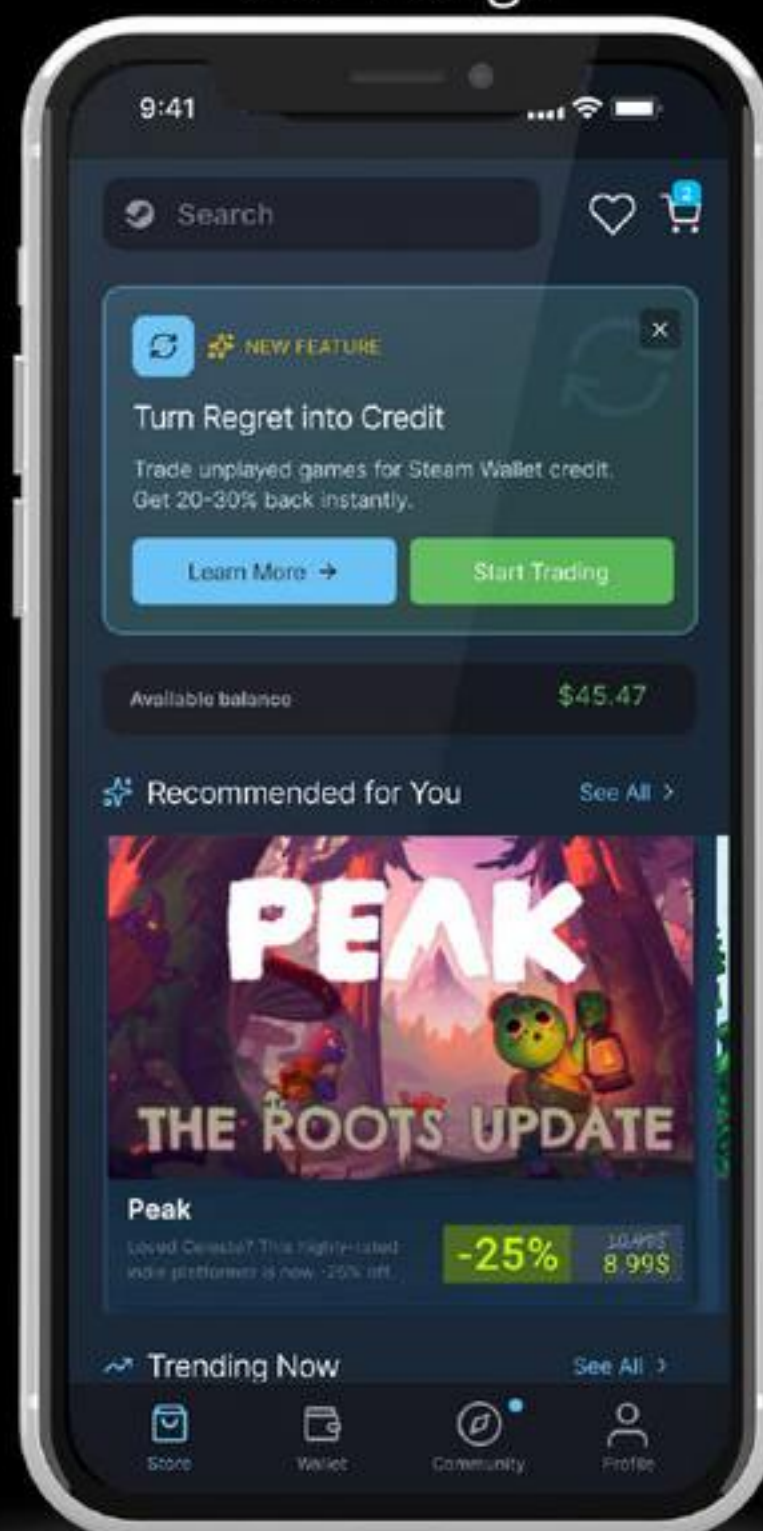


NEW HOME PAGE

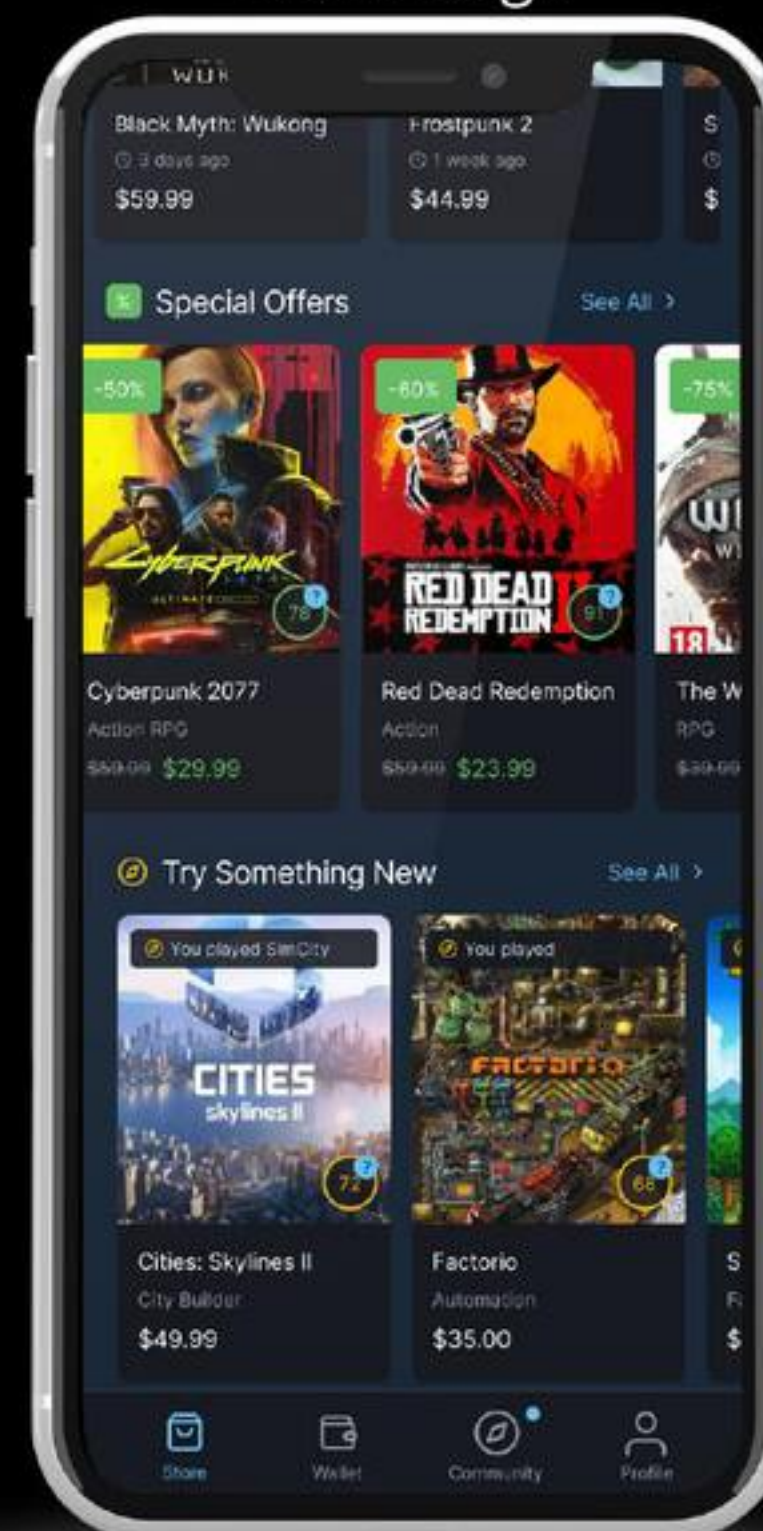
Original



Our Design



Our Design



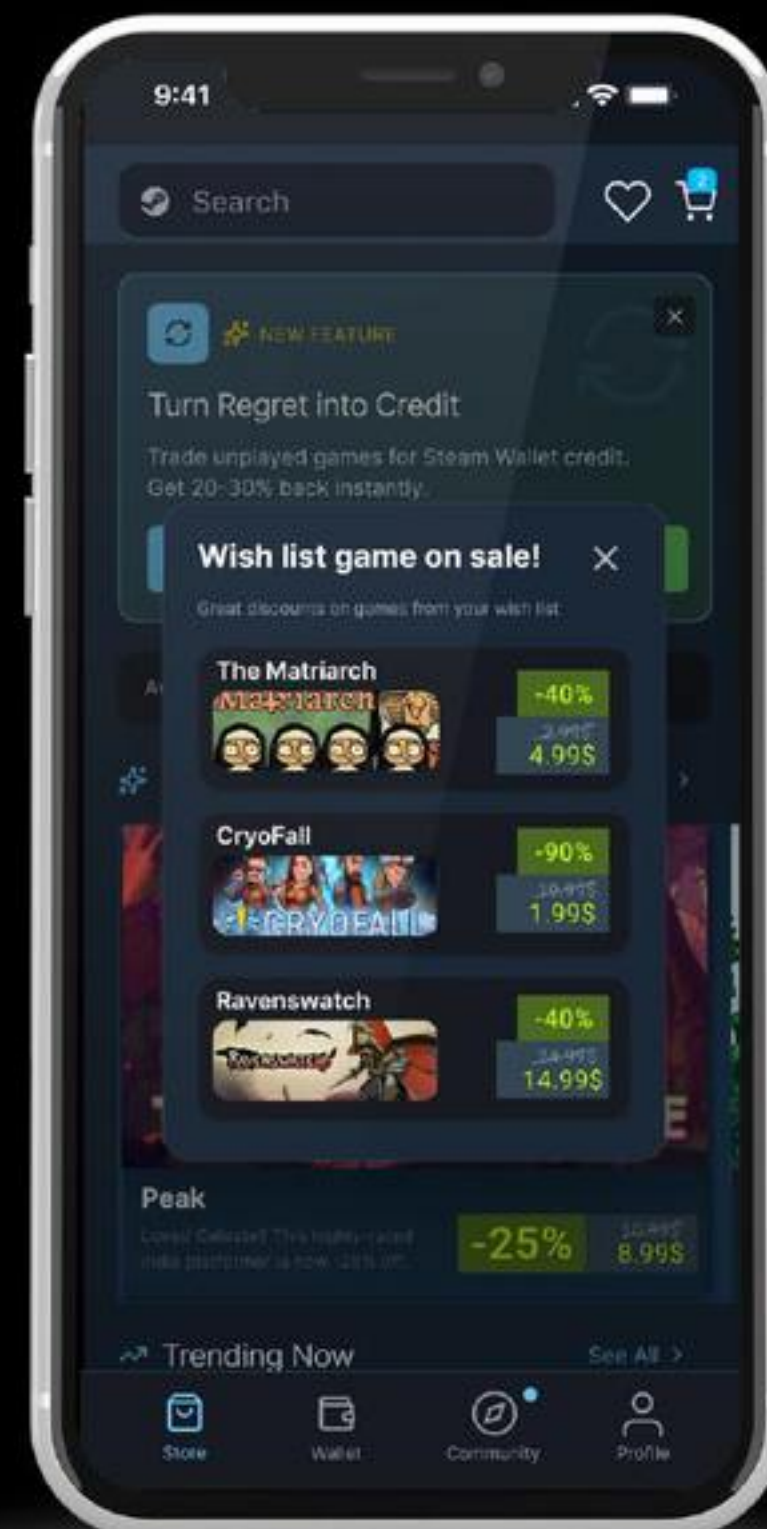


DISCOUNT DISCOVERY

Original



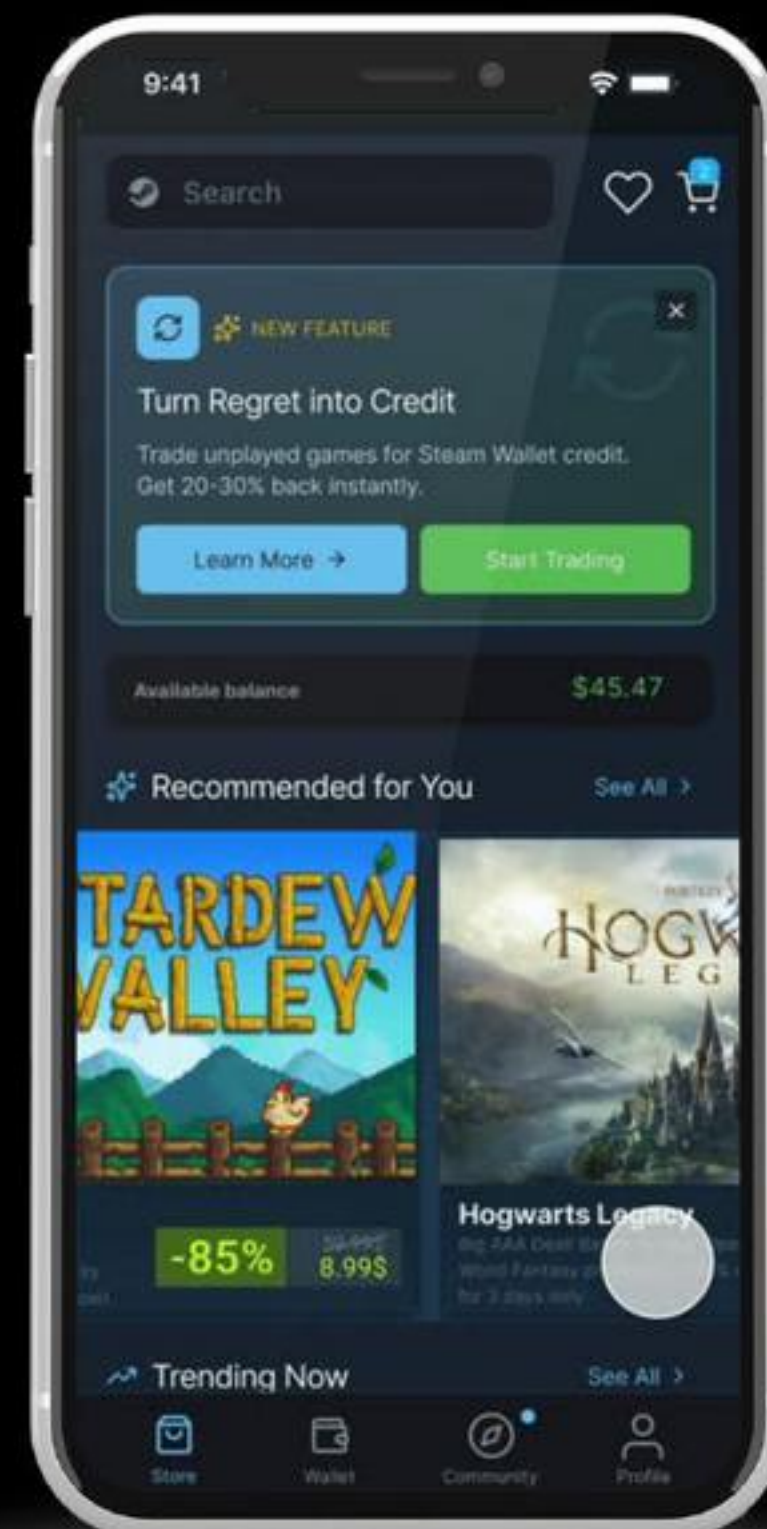
Our Design



Original

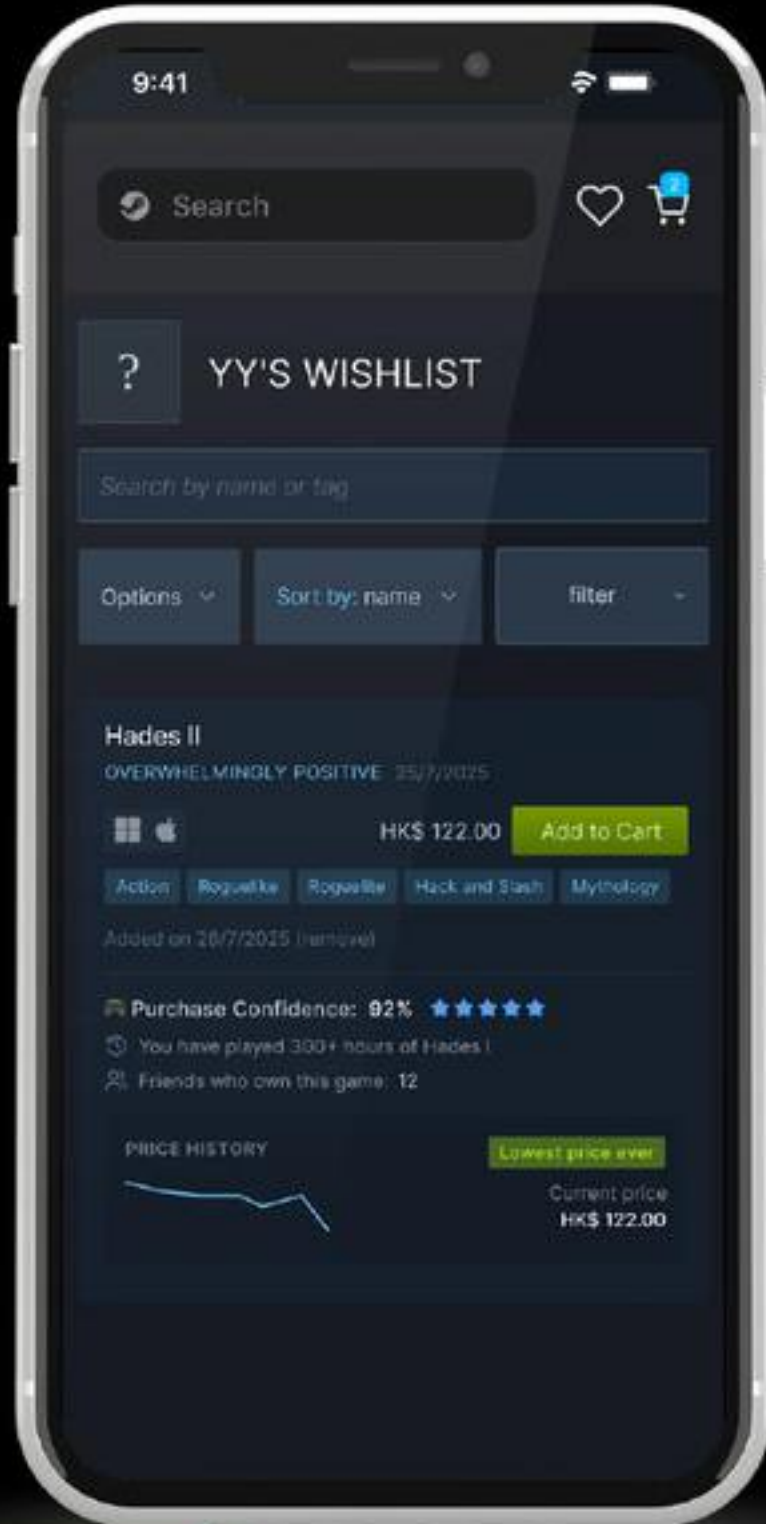


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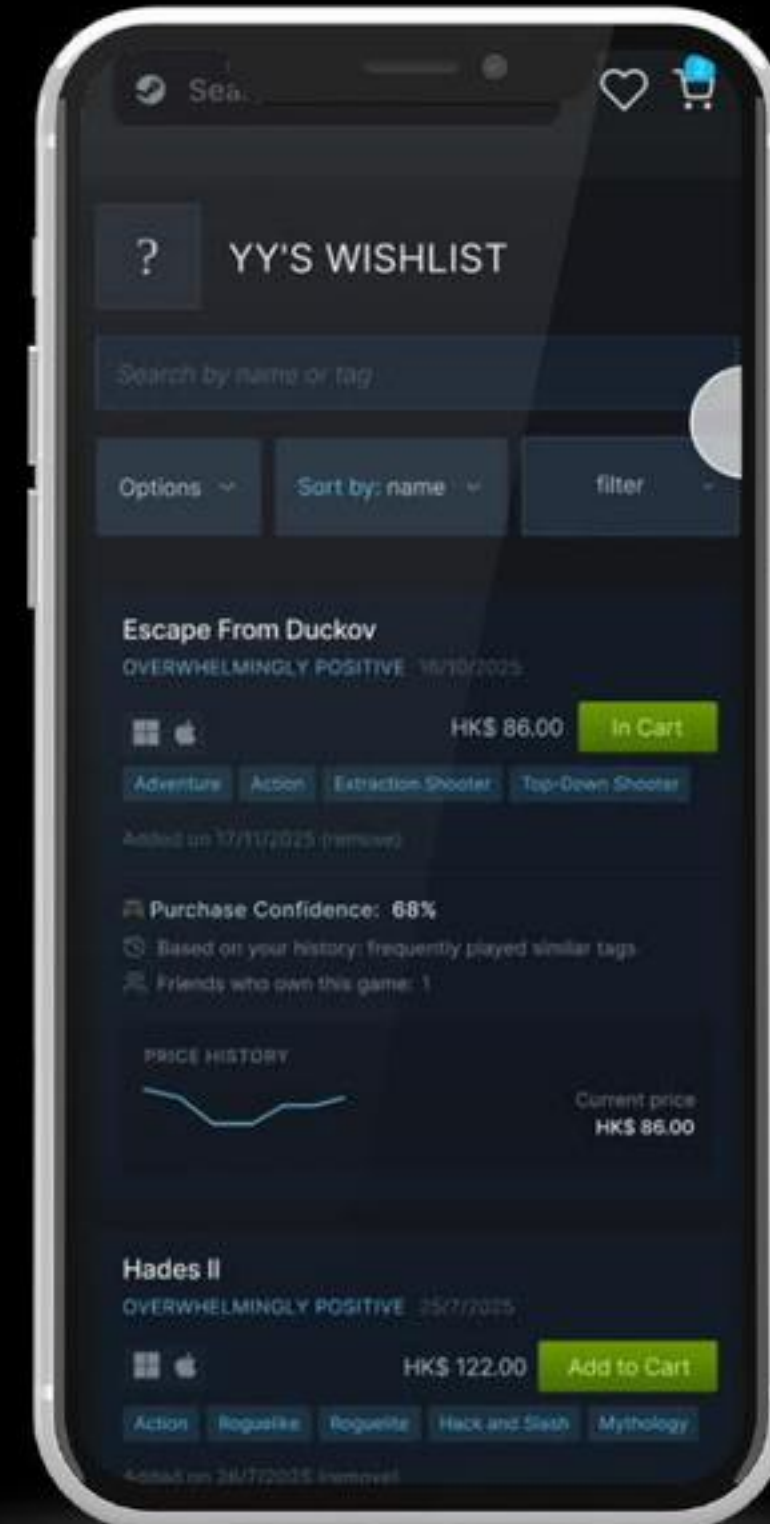


WISHLIST

Original



Our Design

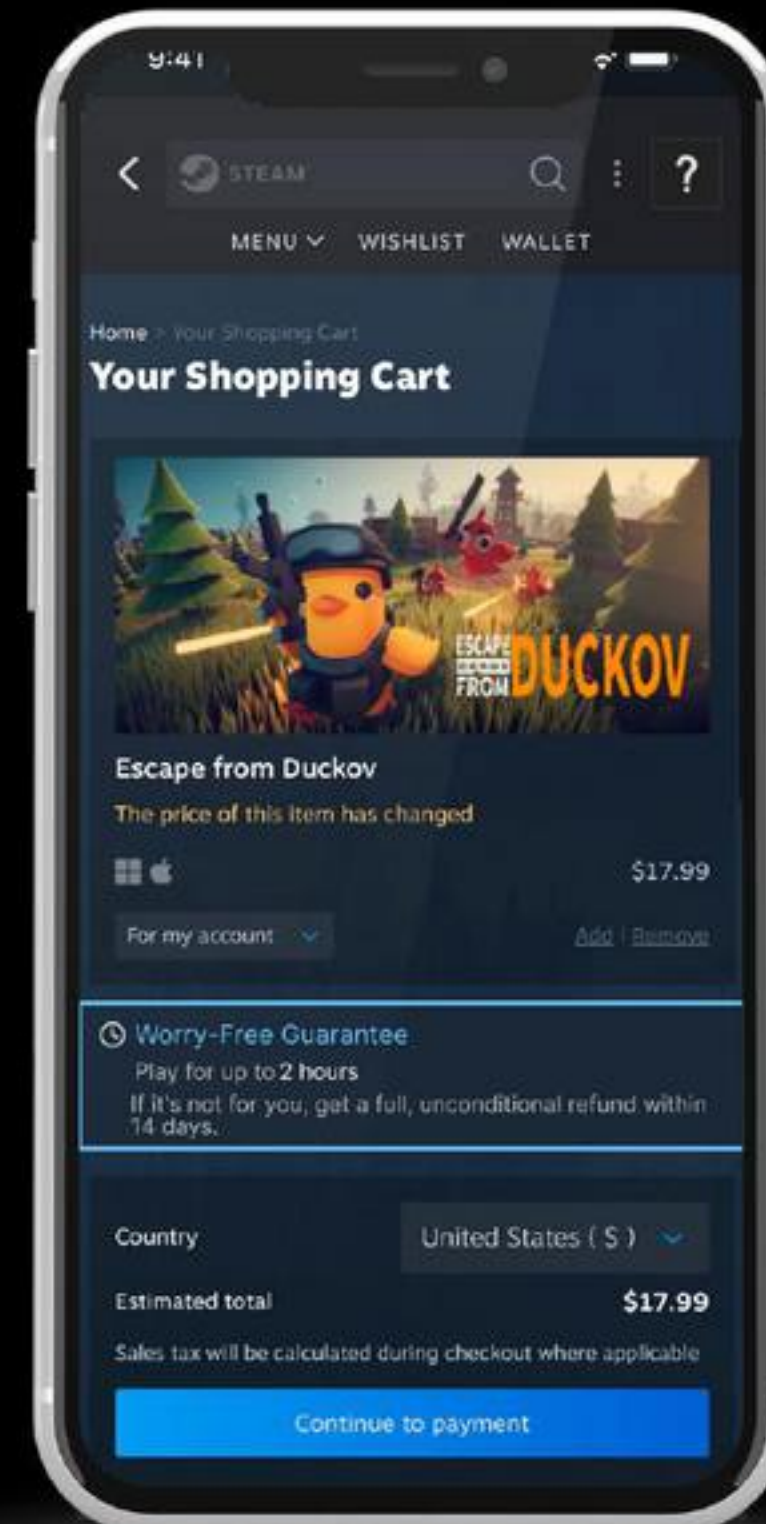


SHOPPING CART

Original



Our Design



FIT SCORE SYSTEM

Original



Our Design



↔ Strong Playstyle Match 92%

STRONG FIT FIT SCORE >

This game strongly matches the way you like to play.

📌 WHY THIS FITS YOUR PLAYSTYLE

🎮 Your Play Style

- Fast-paced
- Shooter-focused
- Immediate feedback

PEAK's Gameplay

- Skill-focused challenges with tight, responsive feedback
- Precise, responsive controls
- Progress driven by mastery and execution

↔ Style Shift Detected 61%

MIXED FIT FIT SCORE >

You prefer fast, instant-action shooters, but PEAK focuses on slow, precision climbing.

📌 WHERE THIS MAY FEEL DIFFERENT

🎮 Your Play Style

- Fast-paced
- Shooter-focused
- Immediate feedback

PEAK's Gameplay

- Slow & deliberate
- Precision platformer
- Methodical movement

↔ Style Mismatch 27%

LOW FIT FIT SCORE >

You usually enjoy fast, instant-action shooters. PEAK plays very differently.

📌 HOW THIS DIFFERS FROM YOUR USUAL PLAYSTYLE

🎮 Your Play Style

- Fast-paced
- Shooter-focused
- Immediate feedback

PEAK's Gameplay

- Focuses on precision platforming
- Emphasizes slow, deliberate movement

TRADE-IN

Onboarding Pages



Paid \$80 → Get \$12-18

Paid \$40 → Get \$8-12

Paid \$30 → Get \$6-9

Fair Value Guaranteed

Get 20-30% of what you paid back as instant Steam Wallet credit. No waiting, no hassle.

Skip

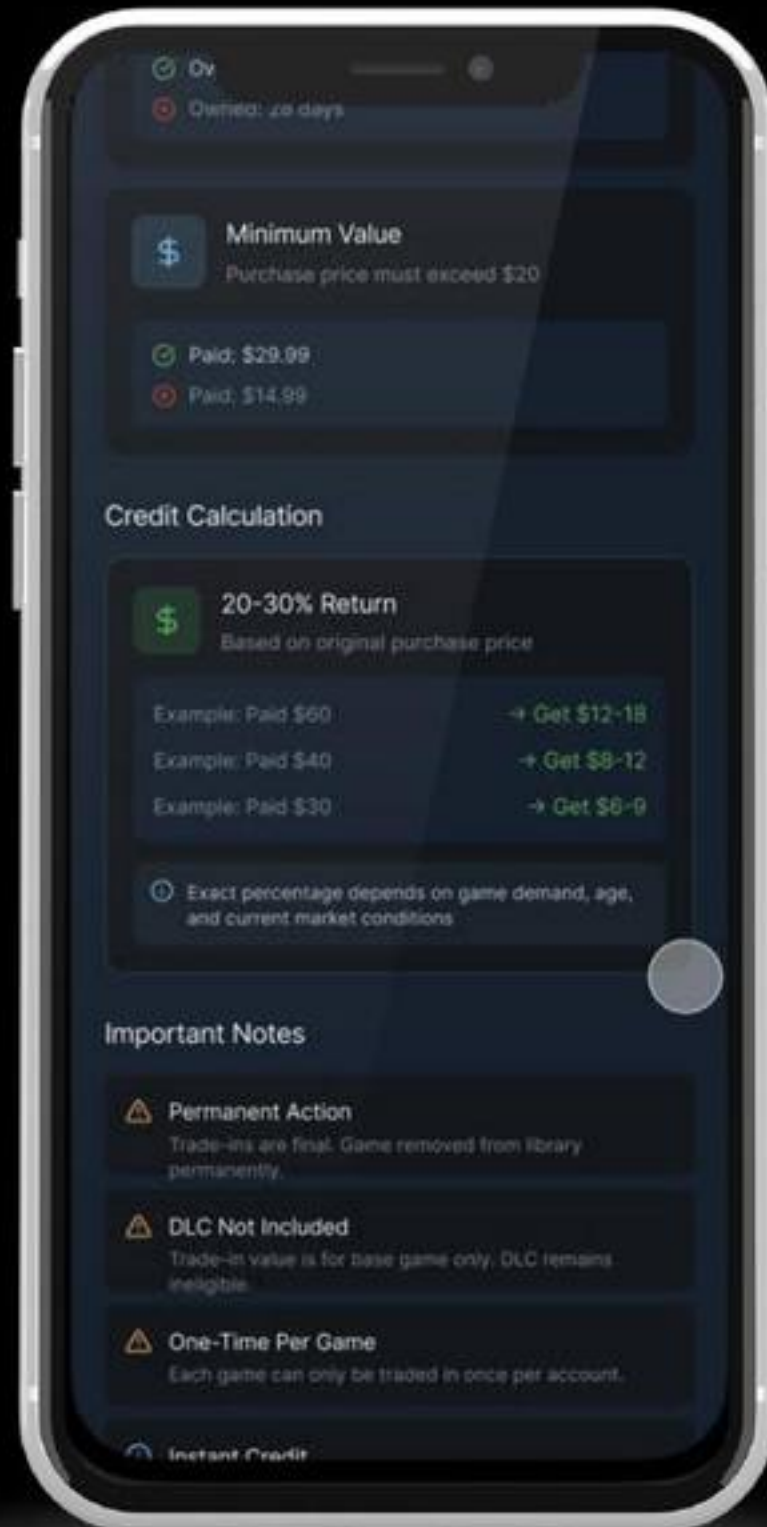
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< Back

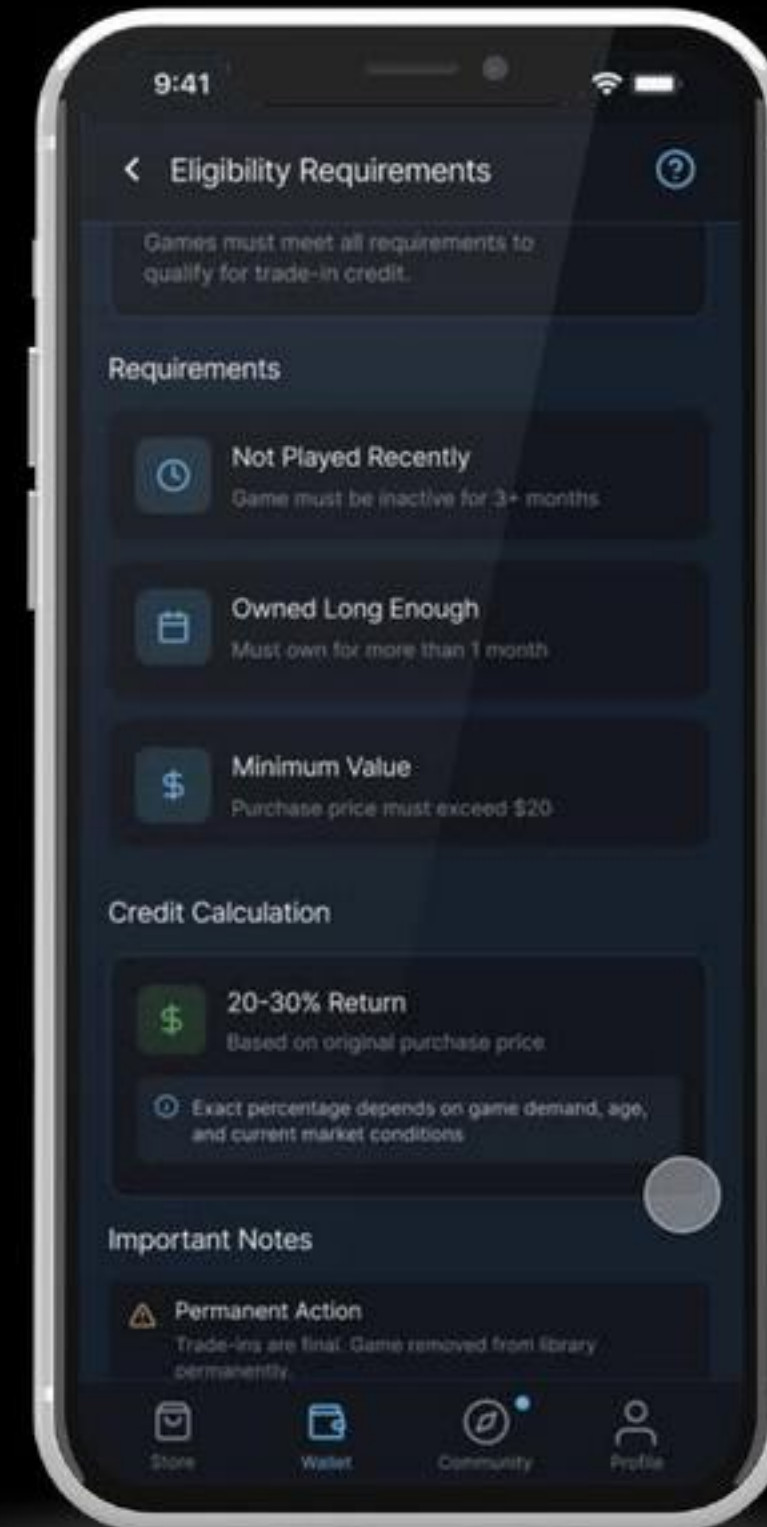
TRADE-IN

Requirement page simplification

before



after



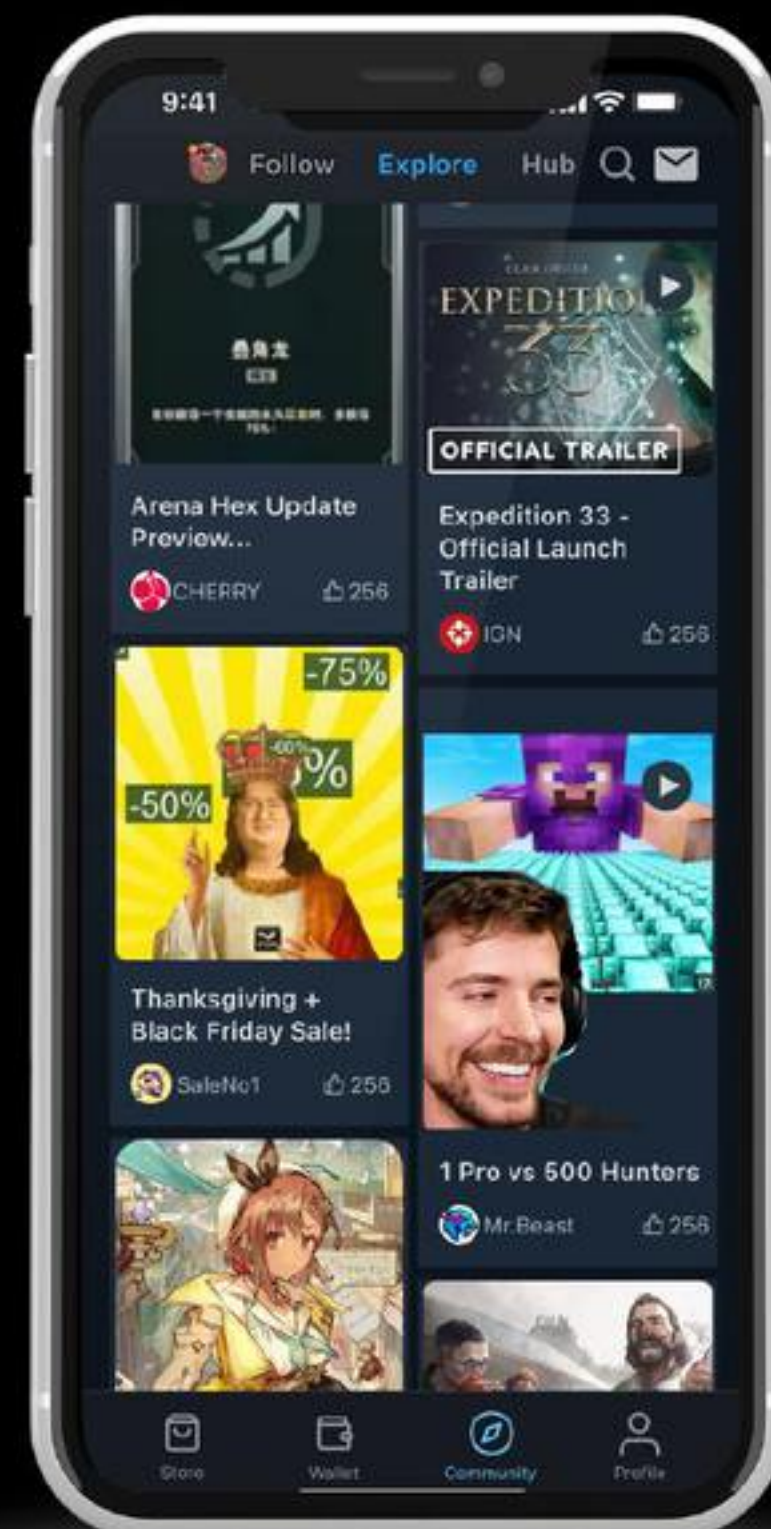
COMMUNITY HUB

Before



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After



Before



After





05

REFLECTION





Users may state preferences
that differ from their actual
behavior.



Sharing different
perspectives helped the
team explore more design
ideas.



Simpler interfaces worked
better than added controls

NEXT STEPS



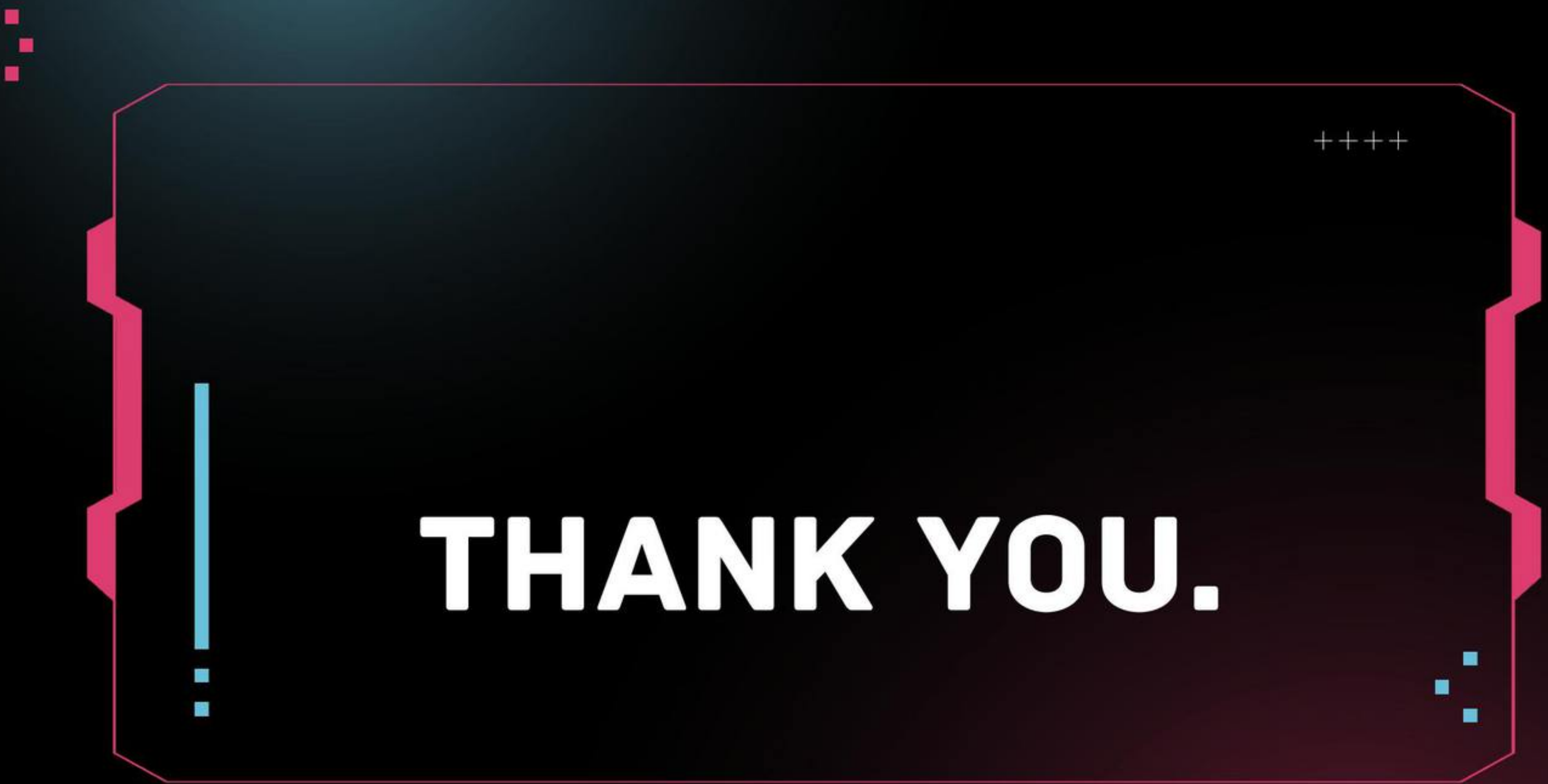
Define success
metrics to measure
improvement



Prioritize features
based on
user/feature value
and effort



Conduct testing to
evaluate results



THANK YOU.